

A review of biosimilar adoption in the setting of originator product removal from a health-system specialty pharmacy

Background

- Clinical specialty pharmacists serve a crucial role in facilitating patients through the transition of an originator product to a biosimilar
- Clinical specialty pharmacists not only educate patients on biosimilar safety and efficacy but also make recommendations to specialists and patients on which biosimilar product to select
- As a health-system pharmacy, we removed the originator product, adalimumab, from the pharmacy medication list due to projected cost-savings and market trends

Table 1: Pharmacist Directed Substitution Policy

Pharmacy and Therapeutics Policy

- Pharmacist-directed substitution allowed subject to following:
- Biosimilar must have FDA approval
 - For non-interchangeable status, pharmacist must use professional expertise to select biosimilar
 - Practice in accordance with the Illinois Pharmacy Practice Act pertaining to biological products

Purpose

- To describe the initiatives taken, challenges faced, and lessons learned by a health-system pharmacy in the setting of an originator product removal

Methods

Study Design:

- Retrospective, descriptive study
- Focused on the removal of an originator product (adalimumab) from the health-system specialty pharmacy serviced medication list occurring from 12/1/2024 until 3/1/2025

Methodology:

- Created guidance for pharmacists with pharmacy and therapeutics biosimilar substitution policy
- Disseminated information to prescribing specialists
- Ensured notification of originator product removal to patients
- Counseled on recommended change to respective insurance preferred biosimilar(s)

Objectives

Primary Objective:

- Number of patients transitioned to a biosimilar

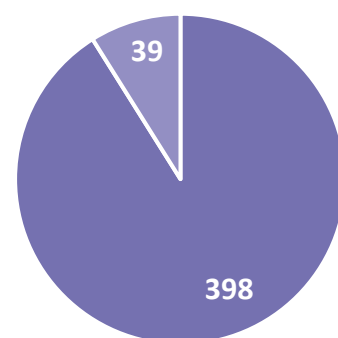
Secondary Objectives:

- Number of patients who remained on originator product and sought originator product from an alternative specialty pharmacy
- Adalimumab (originator product and biosimilars) drug spend within health-system specialty pharmacy
- Adalimumab purchase volume within health-system pharmacy

Results

Figure 1: Adalimumab Patients (Biosimilar Acceptance + Originator)

Total Adalimumab Patients (N=437)



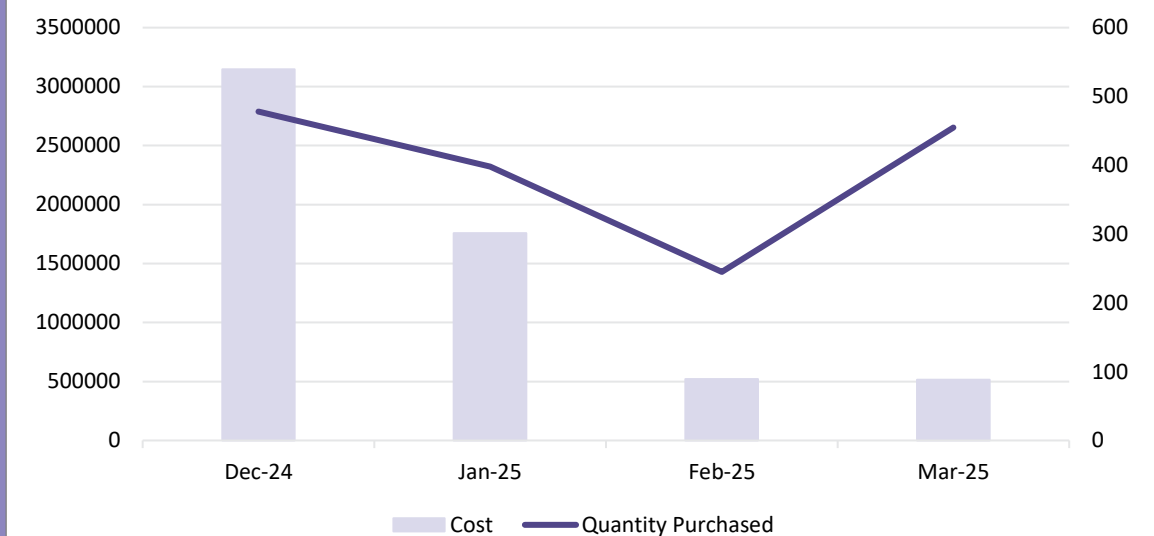
■ Biosimilar ■ Originator Product

The majority of patients were agreeable to transition to an adalimumab biosimilar

Overall purchase volume remained constant during the study period (Figure 2). Total volume decreased by 23 units between December to March

Results

Figure 2: Adalimumab Spend (Originator Product + Biosimilars)
Adalimumab Total Spend



Total adalimumab drug spend was reduced 83.6% (2.63 million) from project start date to end date with the removal of originator product

Conclusions

- Biosimilar adoption was largely successful due to biosimilar acceptance from health-system specialists, removal of originator product from pharmacy medication list, and well-established pharmacy to patient relationships
- Many challenges were faced throughout the project period including navigating insurance formulary preferences, availability of biosimilar strengths, formulations, and starter kits, dissemination of information to patients, biosimilar shortages, and private-label biosimilar manufacturing
- With more biosimilars on the horizon, and the opportunity for cost-savings, this project can serve as a framework for health-system pharmacies looking to remove an originator product

Disclosures

No author of this study has any financial or personal relationships with commercial entities that may have a direct or indirect interest in the subject matter of this presentation